MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検2級
リーディングトレーニング

第1回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜17	短文の語句空所補充
2	18〜23	長文の語句空所補充
3	24〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検2級形式のリーディング第1回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) The factory installed new filters to reduce the amount of harmful gas it (　　) into the air.

1 emits　**2** inherits　**3** reserves　**4** approves

(2) The journalist refused to publish the story until she could (　　) the facts.

1 involve　**2** verify　**3** occupy　**4** resist

(3) Several firms are (　　) for the contract, so each is trying to offer the best price.

1 recovering　**2** apologizing　**3** competing　**4** consisting

(4) The island has limited natural (　　), so most building materials must be imported.

1 occasions　**2** beliefs　**3** symptoms　**4** resources

(5) The proposal seems attractive, but its long-term costs have been (　　). They may be much higher than the team expects.

1 underestimated　**2** illustrated　**3** permitted　**4** exchanged

1 短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(6) The committee reached a ( ) after both sides agreed to give up part of their demands.

1 restriction **2** compromise **3** prediction **4** comparison

(7) The instructions are ( ): every participant must wear a helmet, without exception.

1 optional **2** minor **3** explicit **4** flexible

(8) The charity relies heavily on public ( ) to continue providing free meals.

1 departures **2** objections **3** intervals **4** donations

(9) The discovery was not made ( ); it resulted from years of careful observation.

1 by chance **2** in advance **3** on purpose **4** at risk

(10) A shortage of skilled workers has ( ) the company from expanding production.

1 reminded **2** prevented **3** separated **4** distinguished

1 短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(11) The new rules apply to all employees, ( ) their position in the company.

1 instead of **2** in favor of **3** regardless of **4** in exchange for

(12) The town must ( ) enough money for maintaining the flood barriers, not just building them.

1 imitate **2** exclude **3** translate **4** allocate

(13) The patient showed a ( ) improvement, recovering a little more each day.

1 gradual **2** fatal **3** permanent **4** shallow

(14) His argument is based on the ( ) that energy prices will remain stable. If they rise, his conclusion may be wrong.

1 achievement **2** assumption **3** appearance **4** appointment

(15) The city introduced measures to ( ) residents from leaving rubbish in public spaces.

1 enable **2** require **3** discourage **4** persuade

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(16) No sooner had the concert begun (　　) the lights went out.

1 when　**2** that　**3** as　**4** than

(17) The cost of repairing the old device is almost (　　) to the price of a new one.

1 equivalent　**2** familiar　**3** independent　**4** suitable

2

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

When Saving Water Changes Habits

A housing cooperative fitted low-flow shower heads in its apartments. The equipment was designed to use less water each minute while still providing a comfortable shower. Based on the devices' technical specifications, the cooperative expected a substantial reduction in total water use. However, the first three months produced a smaller reduction than expected.

Interviews with residents helped explain the difference. Some people said the new shower felt pleasant and therefore stayed in it longer. Others believed the equipment made water use so small that there was little reason to worry about time. In both cases, a technical improvement had been partly offset by (18). The equipment was working as designed, but this alone did not determine the final result.

The cooperative did not remove the shower heads or blame residents for behaving badly. Instead, it shared simple information about the difference between water used per minute and water used during an entire shower. Residents were also given a way to see their own household's weekly use, rather than compare themselves with a single average household. (19), a family with several children would naturally use more water than someone living alone.

Later results suggested that combining efficient equipment with understandable feedback was more useful than relying on equipment alone. The lesson was not that efficient technology has no value. Rather, organizations should (20) when estimating its benefits. A device can make conservation easier, but the choices people make around it remain important.

(18)

1 changes in residents' behavior
2 a failure to install the equipment
3 an increase in water pressure
4 the absence of technical specifications

(19)

1 Nevertheless
2 For instance
3 On the contrary
4 In the meantime

(20)

1 assume that behavior will never change
2 judge devices only by their purchase price
3 consider how people actually use the technology
4 avoid giving residents information

The Value of an Unfinished List

A coastal town began recording the wildlife found in its public gardens. Volunteers were asked to photograph insects and upload their observations to a shared website. The project attracted many enthusiastic participants, and its first map appeared to show that the central park had far more kinds of insects than any other garden. Some officials suggested concentrating future planting there.

A coordinator examined the observation records more carefully. The central park was close to a bus stop and had a popular cafe, so volunteers visited it frequently. Several smaller gardens had been visited only once. The map therefore reflected not only where insects lived but also (21). Treating every blank area on the map as an absence of wildlife would have been misleading.

The coordinator arranged visits to the less popular gardens and asked participants to spend a similar amount of time at each location. Specialists helped check photographs of insects that were difficult to identify. The revised map still had gaps, but the team marked these openly rather than filling them with guesses. (22), users could distinguish between an area where few insects had been seen and an area that had not yet been studied adequately.

The town eventually used the record to plan a wider network of flowering plants across its gardens. It did not wait until the list contained every possible species. Nevertheless, officials learned to treat the map as a developing source of evidence, not a complete picture. The project's usefulness depended on (23). A visually impressive map was valuable only if its limits were understood.

(21)

1 how much the bus company charged

2 which insects had disappeared permanently

3 how old the public gardens were

4 where volunteers chose to look

(22)

1 Consequently

2 Previously

3 Alternatively

4 Surprisingly enough

(23)

1 hiding uncertainty until every species was listed

2 making the strength and limitations of the evidence clear

3 placing all new flowers in the central park

4 counting photographs without checking them

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Trial of the Flexible Workspace

From: Priya Shah, Facilities Manager
To: Staff in the West Building
Subject: Four-week workspace trial

Dear colleagues,
From next Monday, the third-floor meeting room will be used as a quiet workspace during the morning. This is a four-week trial, not a permanent change. Staff feedback has shown that some tasks require longer periods without interruption than our open office currently allows. The room will remain available for meetings after 1 p.m.

You may reserve a desk through the internal booking page up to two working days ahead. To give more people a chance to participate, please book no more than two mornings per week. If you no longer need a booking, cancel it promptly. Desks cannot be reserved by leaving personal belongings overnight.

During the trial, the room is intended for individual work. Please take telephone and video calls elsewhere, even if you use headphones. There will be no charge to your department for using the room. However, this does not include printing costs, which will continue to be charged in the usual way.

We will record how often desks are used, but the number of bookings will not be our only measure of success. At the end of the trial, participants and their team leaders will be asked whether the arrangement helped them complete suitable tasks and whether it created difficulties for their teams. We also want to hear from staff who wanted to participate but could not find a suitable time.

Please do not assume that the booking rules will remain unchanged after the trial. They will be reviewed along with the room's future use. Send any urgent concerns directly to me rather than waiting for the final survey.

Priya

Trial of the Flexible Workspace — Questions

(24) What is the main purpose of the trial?

1 To replace all meetings with video calls.

2 To provide uninterrupted space for appropriate individual tasks.

3 To introduce a charge for every desk.

4 To reduce the number of employees in the building.

(25) Which statement is consistent with the booking rules?

1 Personal belongings may be left to secure a desk overnight.

2 Each person can reserve every morning of the week.

3 Unneeded reservations should be canceled quickly.

4 Bookings must be made a month in advance.

(26) How will the arrangement be evaluated?

1 Only by counting how many bookings are made.

2 By comparing printing bills between departments.

3 Only by asking people who used the room daily.

4 By combining use records with feedback about effects on work and teams.

A Space for the River

For many years, the people of Bellford regarded their river mainly as a threat. High walls separated it from nearby streets, and a narrow channel carried water quickly through the center of town. The design had protected buildings during many ordinary storms. However, as the town expanded, more roofs and paved surfaces prevented rain from soaking into the ground. Water reached the river faster, and maintaining safety became increasingly difficult.

One response would have been to make the walls higher. Instead, planners proposed allowing the river more room at a former industrial site upstream. Old warehouses there had been removed, leaving land that could temporarily hold water during heavy rain. In dry weather, most of the area could be used as a public park. The proposal did not eliminate the need for walls elsewhere; it was intended to complement existing defenses.

Some residents objected that a park designed to flood was a waste of money. They feared that equipment would be damaged and the area would be closed too often. The design team responded by placing expensive electrical equipment above expected water levels and choosing surfaces that could be cleaned after flooding. Path signs explained that lower routes might close, while a higher route would remain available under most conditions.

A more difficult question concerned who would benefit. The park was near a neighborhood with few green spaces, but many people living there had not attended the early planning meetings. The meetings had been held during working hours and relied on technical presentations. The town changed the schedule and used a temporary model that residents could walk around. This led to requests for better lighting, places to sit, and a safer crossing to the park.

After the park opened, a severe storm tested the design. Water spread across the lower ground as intended, and some paths were closed for cleaning afterward. Officials resisted describing this as a failure of the park: temporary flooding was part of its protective function. At the same time, they acknowledged that the cleanup had taken longer than expected and revised the maintenance plan.

Bellford's experience illustrates why adapting to floods involves more than building a single structure. The physical design, the ability to maintain it, and the ways people understand and use it all matter. A project can serve several purposes, but those purposes need to be explained honestly. Calling a floodable park permanently dry would create false expectations; treating it only as empty storage would overlook its everyday value to residents.

A Space for the River — Questions

(27) Why had the old flood defenses become less adequate?

1 More paved areas sent rainwater into the river quickly.

2 The town had stopped experiencing storms.

3 The river had been permanently closed.

4 Residents had removed all the protective walls.

(28) What role was the new park intended to play?

1 Replace every wall throughout the town.

2 Add temporary water storage while offering everyday public space.

3 Prevent all water from ever reaching the river.

4 Return the former warehouses to industrial use.

(29) Why did the town change its public meetings?

1 Residents had asked for more technical language.

2 The model had been damaged during a flood.

3 The original format had excluded some nearby residents in practice.

4 Officials wanted to avoid questions about safety.

(30) How did officials respond after the severe storm?

1 They announced that no further maintenance was necessary.

2 They closed the park permanently because water entered it.

3 They denied that cleaning had caused any difficulty.

4 They distinguished intended flooding from a maintenance problem that needed improvement.

(31) Which statement best expresses the article's conclusion?

1 Successful adaptation requires design, maintenance, participation, and honest explanation of functions.

2 A floodable park is useful only when it contains no visitors.

3 Technical structures make public understanding unnecessary.

4 Projects serving more than one purpose should always be rejected.